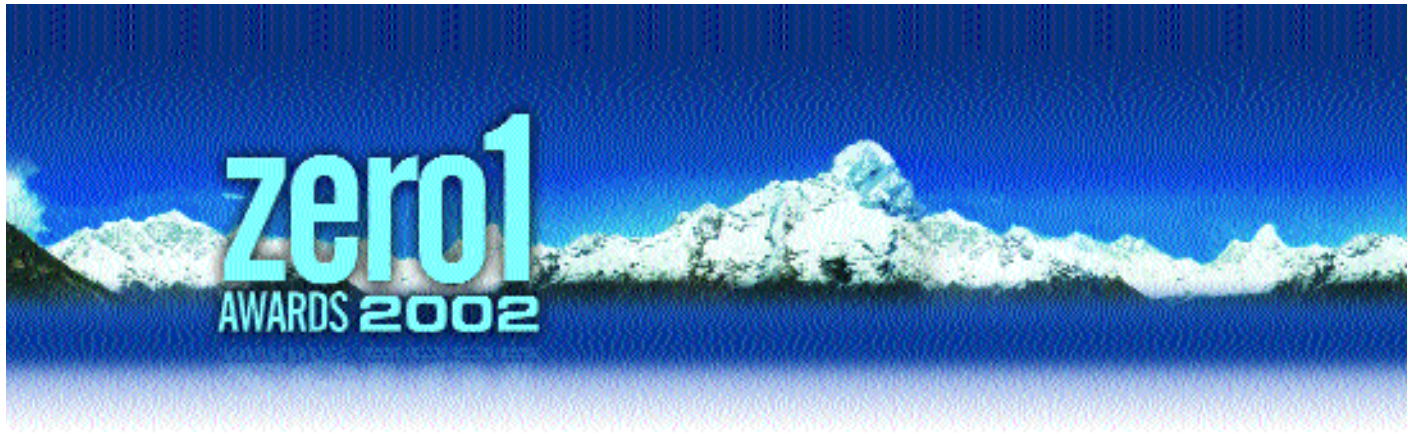
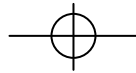




INKJET PRINTERS

Inkjet printers bring all those visualisations, documents, presentations and pictures to vivid life on paper. While most high-quality printers in the beginning of the year touched resolutions of 1440-dpi, towards the end of the year we saw the best of the pack boasting print resolutions of up to 2400-dpi—and there seems to be no signs of this rise in resolutions stopping.

Read the fine print

When talking about the performance of a printer, there are two parameters that should be kept in mind—print quality and printing speed. In print quality, the primary factor that determines the clarity is the resolution of the printer—the greater the resolution, the greater is the number of dots it can pack into a unit of area on a page. The latest printers support print resolutions of up to 2400 dpi, which results in photo-quality prints when using the correct paper. Before buying a printer, always analyse a sample print under best quality mode and make sure it meets your quality needs.

If you are looking for quality, the type of paper supported and the setting of the driver are two very important factors. For the best possible prints, make sure that your printer prints on special kinds of paper such as coated, glossy or inkjet paper, as this results in superior quality printouts. Also see that the printer has special modes of printing images and photographs.

Secondly, analyse the print speed—this is largely dependent on the type of document being printed. In the case of graphics-intensive documents, the speeds would

Nominees

Name	Contacts	Comments
HP Deskjet 920C	Hewlett-Packard India Ltd, Ph: 011-6826000	This printer sports a print resolution of 2400-dpi and features a 2 MB buffer. It delivered excellent results in photo printing
Canon S4500	Canon India Ltd, Ph: 011-6806572	Based on a 1440-dpi print engine, this bubble jet printer delivers excellent results when printing graphically demanding images

understandably be lower than while printing plain text. An inkjet printer should have a text printout rate of about 10 pages per minutes (ppm). In the case of colour photo printing, the time taken will vastly vary according to the type of image and the quality chosen.

While looking for speed, print using draft or economy mode as this uses less ink and subsequently takes less time to print. Finally, the interface plays an important role, especially if you print in large quantities or if you print graphical files. A faster interface such as USB allows the printer to spool print information much faster than an older interface such as a parallel port. Finally, choose a printer with a print buffer of at least 64 KB. The larger the amount of buffer memory, the faster the printing of larger files such as photographs.



HP Deskjet 970Cxi
Hewlett Packard India Ltd,
Ph: 011-6826000

The verdict: With an astounding 2400-dpi print capability and 4 MB of buffer memory, this printer delivered stunning results in photo printing and graphically demanding applications

And the award goes to...

The best inkjet printer this year was the HP 970Cxi. With its formidable 2400-dpi print resolution, capability and support for a variety of papers, it has produced truly stunning prints and delivered excellent performance when it came to print speeds over large files. It even managed to impress us in the professional print domain.

PAGE LAYOUT SOFTWARE

Adobe InDesign 2.0

In the battle for the perfect page layout software, Adobe InDesign 2.0 proved its mettle. With its extensive support for text and image handling, it makes working with complex files such as brochures and magazines a snap. InDesign has special support for working with image files from within the program itself, therefore, you don't need to resort to a separate image editing software. Its ability to handle text effects and tables is far superior compared to other page layout software and

tables can be imported directly from Word and Excel files. The magic of layers has been exploited well. It can also open files from other applications such as Quark Express.



Adobe InDesign 2.0
Adobe systems India Pvt
Ph: 914532026

The verdict: Adobe InDesign is a very powerful text and picture handling capabilities, and gets top marks in the page layout software category. For users of Adobe professional applications, this application sports a similar interface.

